

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 32

By Watson

A RESOLUTION to honor and recognize the Bachman-McCoy Farm on the occasion of the property being placed in the National Register of Historic Places.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that this General Assembly salute that most noble institution, the family farm, which has served as a cornerstone of our communities for more than two centuries; and

WHEREAS, one such noteworthy family farm is the Bachman-McCoy Farm, which, upon the nomination of the Tennessee Historical Commission, has been placed in the National Register of Historic Places by the National Park Service of the United States Department of the Interior; and

WHEREAS, this notable property is also listed in the Tennessee Register of Historic Places; and

WHEREAS, located along historic Anderson Pike near the top of the famed W Road in the Town of Walden on Signal Mountain, the Bachman-McCoy farm was listed in the National Register for its association with significant events in American history, as Bachman family members have played important roles in local politics, social reform causes, and environmental preservation over the years; and

WHEREAS, in 1911, Nathan and Pearl Bachman purchased the property as a summer home; by 1918, the Bachmans had transformed the property into a full-time residence and gentleman's farm; and

WHEREAS, with the farm serving as his home base, Nathan L. Bachman rose in prominence in Tennessee's political world; he served on the Tennessee Supreme Court and as an important southern Senator in the U.S. Congress from 1933 to 1936 during the first phase of

the New Deal, playing an important role in the creation of the Tennessee Valley Authority and the passage of the Social Security Act; and

WHEREAS, Pearl Duke Bachman, Senator Bachman's wife, had significant involvement in the local Garden Club movement and was an early advocate for land conservation and other social causes; and

WHEREAS, their daughter, Martha Bachman McCoy, became a powerful voice for highway beautification and reverence for history, good citizenship, and mountain unity; and

WHEREAS, Martha Bachman McCoy and her family became the farm's primary residents circa 1940; and

WHEREAS, Mrs. McCoy and her daughter, Sally McCoy Garland, allowed the Town of Walden to acquire the farm through a gift/sale, so that the land might serve the community as an arboretum, natural area, and venue for public and private events; and

WHEREAS, today, the property, known as McCoy Farm and Gardens, covers thirty-eight acres and contains the historic home, barn, and outbuildings of the Bachman farming era, as well as many gardens, a Level 2 arboretum, and 2.4 miles of trails; and

WHEREAS, McCoy Farm and Gardens is open daily, hosts various community events, offers a venue for private events, and is enjoyed by the broader community for its natural beauty and historic charm; and

WHEREAS, this General Assembly finds it appropriate to honor the Bachman-McCoy family for their many contributions to social causes, environmental preservation, and good citizenship and their generosity in giving their farm to the Walden community, so that present and future generations may learn history and enjoy nature while visiting the property; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH
GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF

REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor and recognize the Bachman-McCoy Farm on the occasion of the property being placed in the National Register of Historic Places and commemorate the many accomplishments and contributions of the Bachman-McCoy family.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.